

The September 15 Repricing Checklist

Airbnb is replacing the split-fee model with one **15.5% host-only fee** taken from your payout — guests stop paying a service fee at checkout. Do nothing and your payout drops ~12%. Work through this top to bottom before your date above.

☐ 1 Find your break-even number

The price increase that keeps your payout **exactly flat** is **+14.8%** (current price ÷ 0.845). The +18.3% figure circulating in host groups nets you your full current sticker price — that's a raise, fine if you intend it, but know which one you're choosing.

CURRENT NIGHTLY RATE	× 1.148 =	NEW RATE (PAYOUT FLAT)	CLEANING FEE × 1.148	PET / EXTRA-GUEST × 1.148
_____		_____	_____	_____

☐ 2 Raise your other fees by the same percentage

The 15.5% comes off your **whole booking subtotal** — cleaning fee, pet fee, extra-guest fee — not just the nightly rate. Hosts who only reprice the rate quietly eat the difference on every fee they charge.

☐ 3 Know what your guests will see

Your sticker price goes up, but guests stop paying the ~14% service fee — so their **checkout total stays roughly flat**. Expect your listing to look pricier in search results next to hosts who haven't repriced yet. That resolves as the market catches up.

☐ 4 Watch bookings for 2–3 weeks, adjust with data

Nobody knows exactly how demand shifts when every US listing repriced at once. Note your booking pace before the change, compare after, and adjust from numbers — not from the panic in the Facebook groups.

☐ 5 Re-check your co-host arrangement

If a co-host takes a percentage, the fee change moves their math too — agree on whether their cut applies before or after the 15.5% so nobody feels shorted in October.

☐ 6 Get your bookkeeping ready for the flip

From day one your payout is **net of 15.5%**, but your 1099-K still reports **gross**. Keep the fee visible as a deductible expense (Schedule E, commissions line) — or you'll overpay tax on money you never received. Your 2026 export will contain both fee models; track actual fee amounts, not estimates.

☐ 7 Thinking of going direct instead? Run the math first

Direct booking isn't fee-free: ~3% card processing, a booking engine, your own marketing, and every booking your site fails to capture costs you a full night. It's a number, not a feeling — calculate it before you leave.

Free calculators for the math above: fee change side by side — tryblackcat.com/tools/airbnb-fee-calculator.html · direct booking vs Airbnb — tryblackcat.com/tools/direct-booking-vs-airbnb-calculator.html

Black Cat Analytics tracks your actual payouts, fees, and expenses per property — so September's change (and your 1099-K) reconciles automatically. Free to start at tryblackcat.com. This checklist is general information, not tax advice — confirm filing questions with your tax professional. Figures reflect Airbnb's announced host-only fee model as of August 2026.